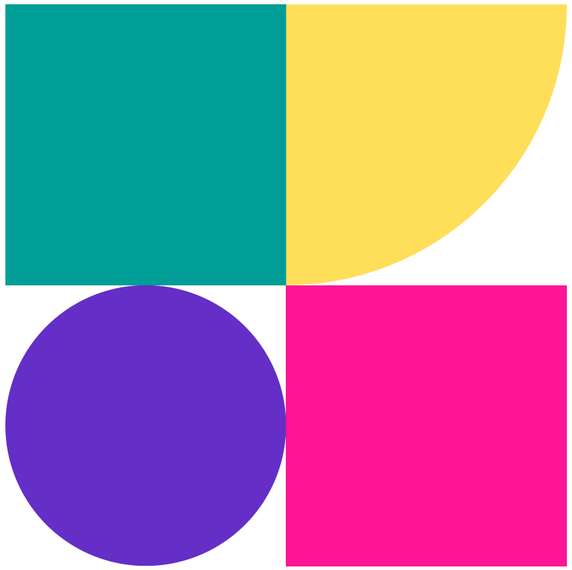


Designing an Academic Poster

key steps on how to stand out in the crowd



What is it?

Think of a poster as your research **elevator pitch**, but visual. It should make people stop, not walk past.

Your poster is not a decoration, it’s your research, **condensed into a single glance.**

If your audience only has 30 seconds, can your research poster tell them the story?

What is it?

Academic posters are more than just large sheets of paper covered in text and images. They are a **visual storytelling tool**, designed to **communicate** research clearly, quickly, and persuasively to an academic audience.

Research posters often serve as the first, and sometimes only, **point of engagement** between you and your peers, examiners, or potential collaborators.



Why Create One?

- **Knowledge Sharing:** Present research findings in a concise and accessible format. Allows complex ideas to be distilled that can be quickly understood by diverse audiences.
- **Visibility and Engagement:** Posters attract attention and create opportunities for conversations. They spark interest, invite questions, and lead to collaborations.
- **Skill Development:** Strengthens essential academic skills: synthesising information, visual communication, and tailoring content for different audiences. This valuable beyond academia.
- **Accessibility:** Posters make research approachable. Highlight main arguments, findings, and implications in a format that is easy to navigate. Even those outside your field can engage with your work.
- **Professional Presence:** Part of your academic identity. It demonstrates the quality of your research AND your ability to communicate it effectively.

1. Know the Conference & Presentation Requirements



Check the guidelines for poster dimensions, layout, and any specific formatting rules.

READ THE BRIEF

2. Understand Your Audience

Tailor your content to the knowledge level of the audience, focusing on clarity and avoiding jargon.

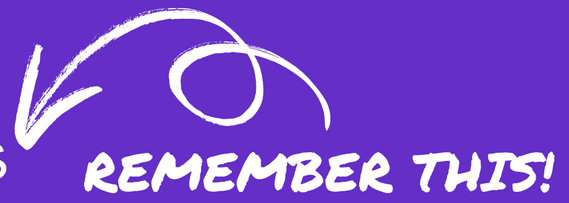
*The primary audience for **your** poster includes staff and academics in the Faculty of Informatics & Design, the IT Department and your peers.*



3. Structure Your Content

Follow a logical structure:

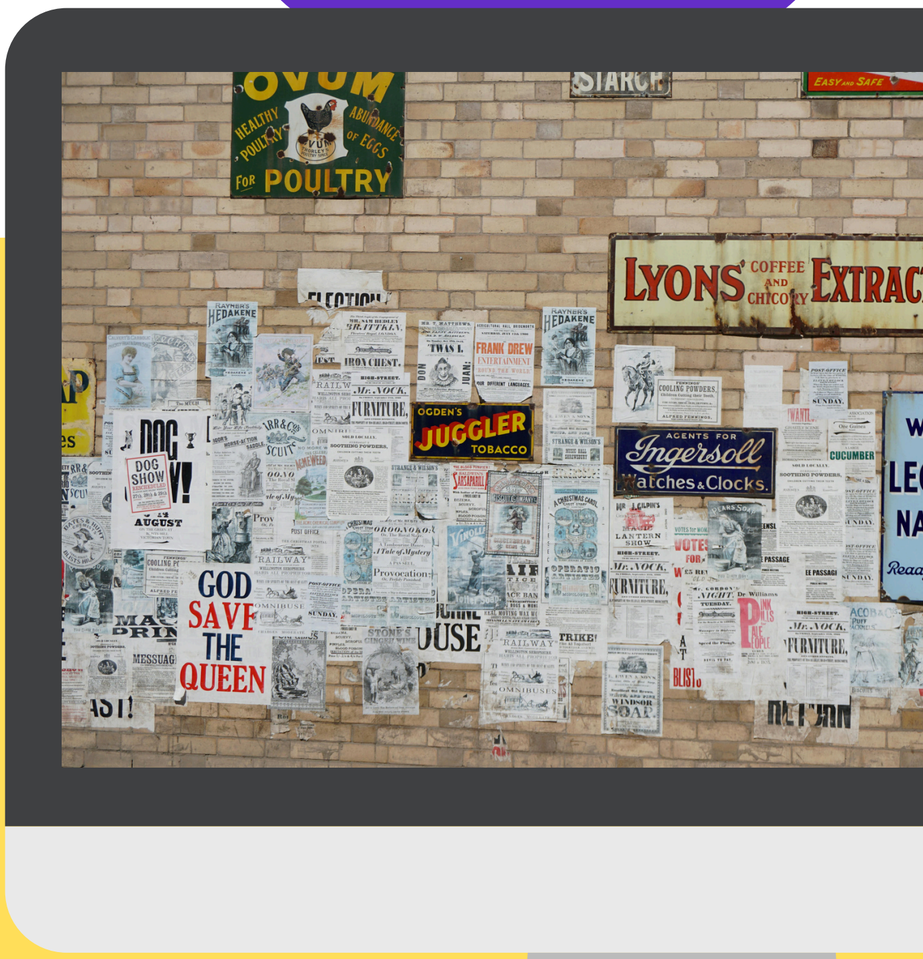
- Title
- Introduction
- Methods
- Results
- Conclusion
- References
- Acknowledgements



Ensure each section is clear and **easy for the eye to navigate.**

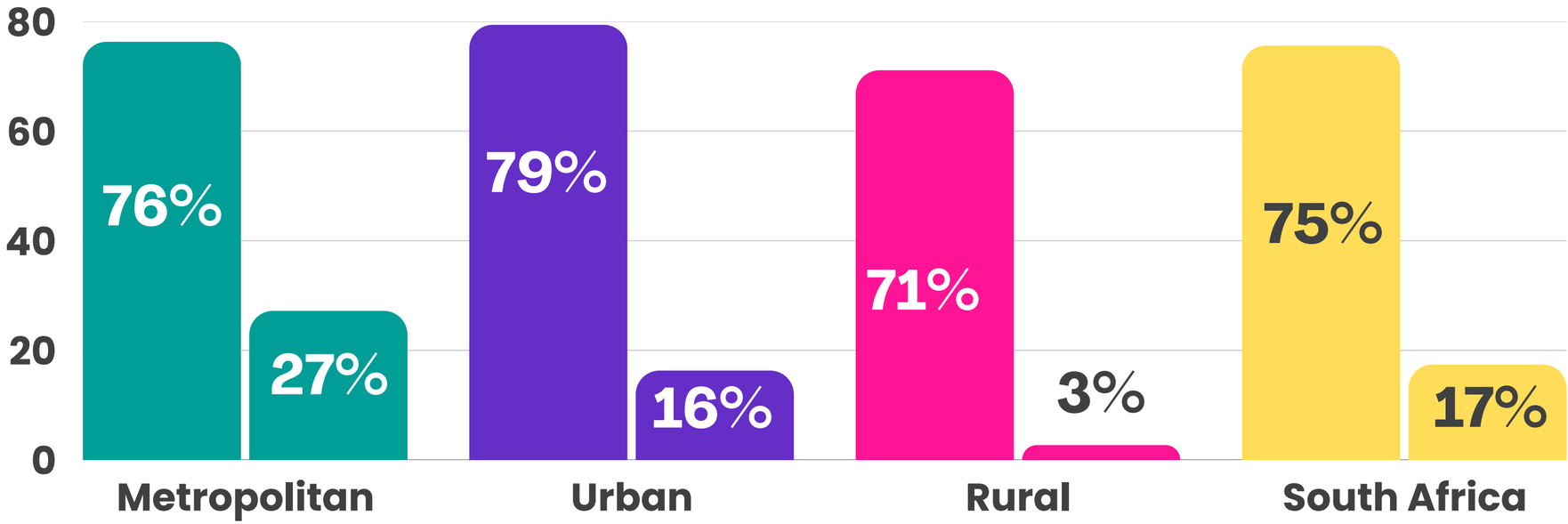
4. Create a Visual Hierarchy

- Use font **sizes** and **headings**, **sub-headings** to guide the reader through your research.
- **Title** and **key findings** should stand out.
- Use bullet points and short paragraphs for **readability**.



5. Balance Text and Visuals

Use graphs, charts, and images to **illustrate** key findings. **Limit text** to the essentials, focusing on visuals to communicate data.



6. Choose Appropriate Colours

Use a professional, cohesive colour scheme. Ensure there's enough **contrast** between **text and background** for legibility.





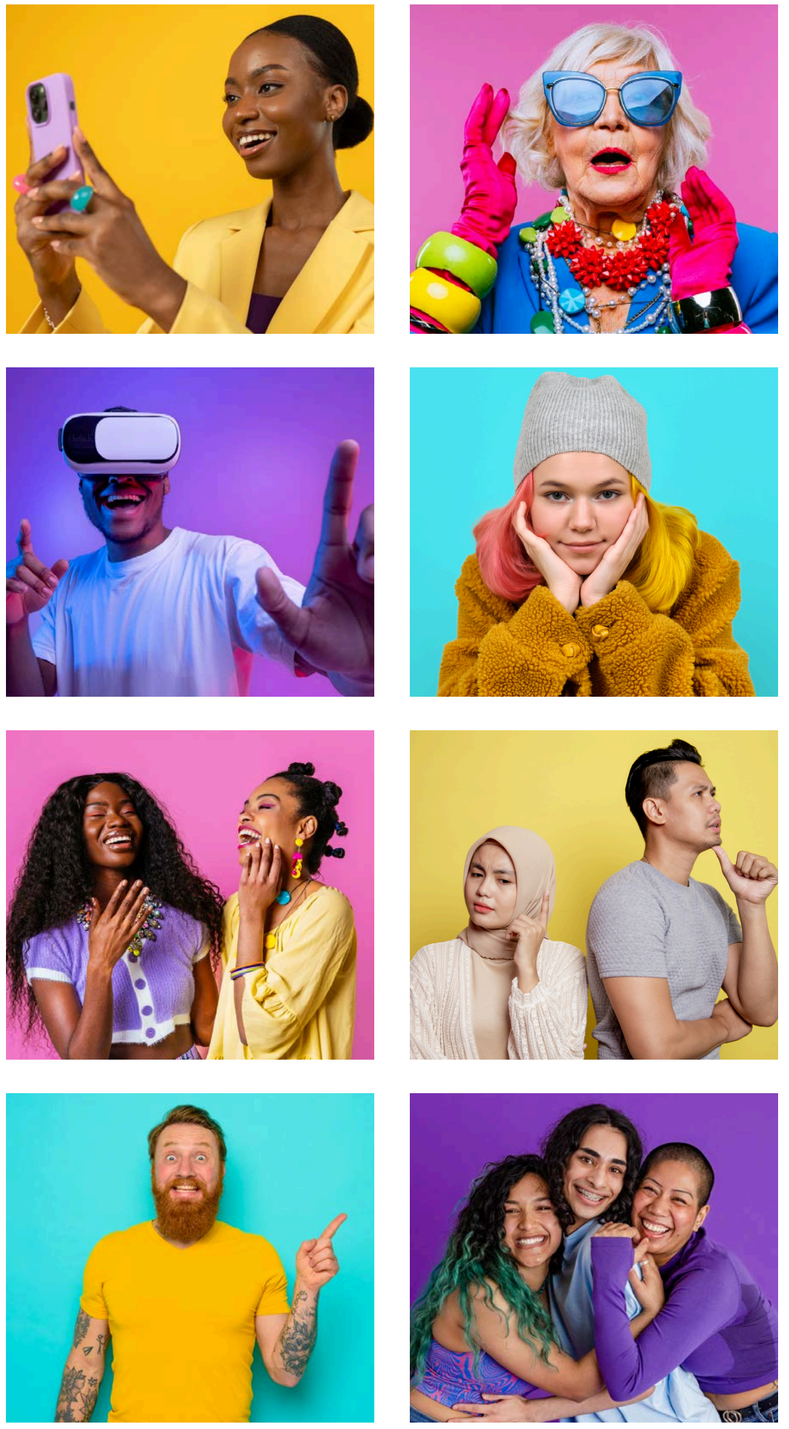
7. Use Readable Fonts

Choose simple, readable fonts. Sans serif fonts are generally easier to read. Be mindful of the amount of text you have vs the amount of space.

Ensure headings are large enough to read from a distance, and the body text is clear and legible.

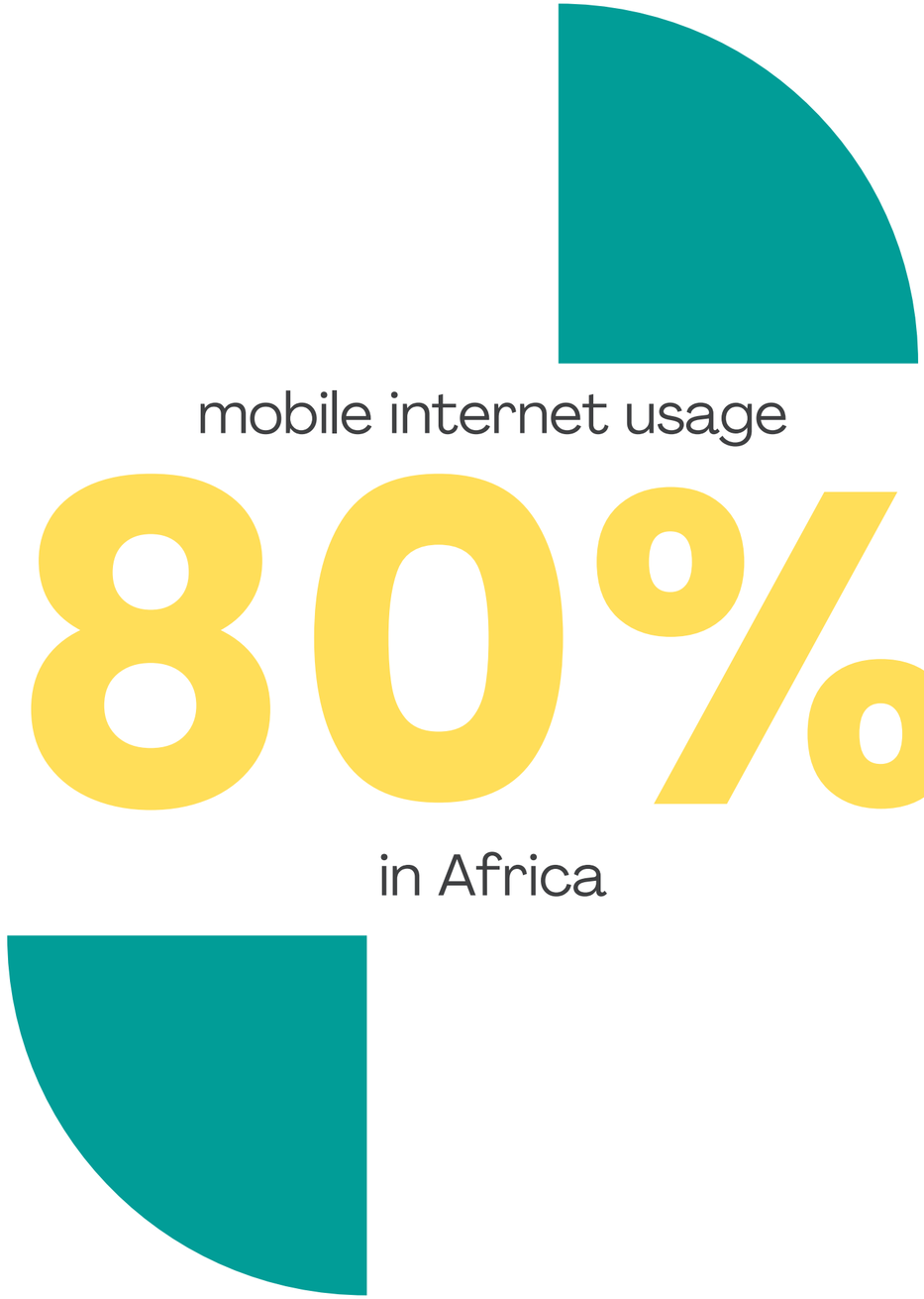
8. Incorporate White Space

Avoid overcrowding the poster. Use white space to separate sections and allow for a clean, organised look.



9. Highlight Key Points

Make sure your main findings or contributions are prominently displayed and easy to locate.



10. Proofread and Get Feedback

Review your poster for accuracy and readability. Have peers or mentors review it and provide feedback before final printing.




What makes a great research poster? [Good and Bad Examples]
Andy Stapleton
Make a Great Research Poster


Designing an Academic Poster
Nutshell Brainery
TITLE
NAMES OF RESEARCHERS, DEPARTMENT, INSITITUTION, CONTACT INFORMATION
ABSTRACT
METHODOLOGY
RESULTS CONT.
DISCUSSION
FIGURE 2
FIGURE 3
FIGURE 5
INTRODUCTION
RESULTS
FIGURE 1
FIGURE 4
Watch on YouTube

TITLE

NAMES OF RESEARCHERS, DEPARTMENT, INSITITUTION, CONTACT INFORMATION

ABSTRACT

INTRODUCTION



FIGURE 1

METHODOLOGY

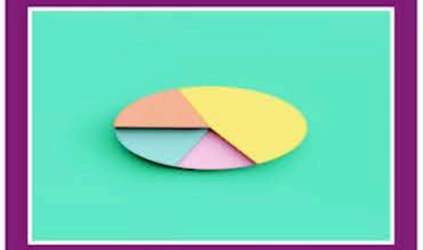


FIGURE 2

RESULTS

RESULTS CONT.

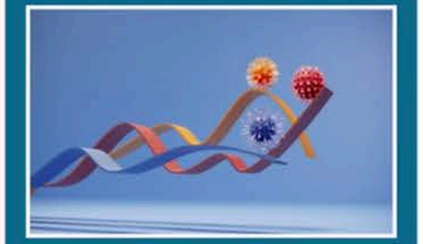


FIGURE 3



FIGURE 4

DISCUSSION



FIGURE 5

REFERENCES

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

THE OFFICE

HOUSE RULES, INSIDE JOKES & MORE

OFFICE CELEBRATION

Today we celebrate the biggest office achievement

57 STOCKISTS
All over the world

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BE A good HUMAN

OUR OFFICE INSIDE JOKES

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FUN STORY



MONTHLY HEROES

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@REALLYGREATSITE

The artistic PROCESS

01

The artist

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Creative Ideas

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Artwork

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THE USE OF GRAPHS

for effective communication

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